



Republic of the Philippines
CITY OF VALENZUELA
Metropolitan Manila

SANGGUNIANG PANLUNGSOD

*** Excerpts from the Minutes of the 49th Regular Session of the 10th City Council of Valenzuela held on August 12, 2026 at 3:00 P.M. at the City Council's Session Hall, 3rd Floor, Legislative Building, Valenzuela City Hall, Karuhatan, Valenzuela City, Metropolitan Manila

ORDINANCE NO. 1372
Series of 2026

AN ORDINANCE STRENGTHENING THE PRE-MARRIAGE ORIENTATION AND COUNSELLING (PMOC) PROGRAM THROUGH THE ADOPTION AND IMPLEMENTATION OF CPD-DOH-DSWD-PSA-DILG JOINT MEMORANDUM CIRCULAR NO.1 SERIES OF 2018.

Authored by : Coun. EXEQUIEL D. SERRANO

WHEREAS, Article XV Section 1 of the 1987 Philippine Constitution mandates the State to recognize the Filipino family as the foundation of the nation and shall strengthen its solidarity and actively promote its total development. Section 2 of the same Article recognizes marriage as an inviolable social institution that is the foundation of the family and thus, shall be protected by the State;

WHEREAS, Presidential Decree 965 and Section 15 of the Responsible Parenthood and Reproductive Health Law require couples who apply for marriage license to present a Certificate of Compliance, certifying that they had duly received adequate instructions and information on responsible parenthood, family planning, breastfeeding and infant nutrition;

WHEREAS, Article 16 of the family Code further requires couples, applying for marriage license, whose ages fall between 18-25 years old, to undergo marriage counselling by a marriage counsellor duly accredited by the Department of Social Welfare and Development;

WHEREAS, Joint Memorandum Circular (JMC) No. 1 series of 2018: Revised Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling (PMOC) Program Implementing Guidelines of 2018 was issued by the Commission on Population and Development (CPD), Department of Interior and Local Government (DILG), Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD), Department of Health (DOH) and the Philippine Statistics Authority (PSA) to streamline and harmonize

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implementation of the Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling (PMOC) Program at the local government level;

WHEREAS, Memorandum Circular 2018-182: Adoption of the Revised Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling (PMOC) Program Implementing Guidelines for 2018 was issued by the DILG enjoining all Local Government Units adopt the JMC No. 1;

NOW THEREFORE, be it **ORDAINED** as it is hereby **ORDAINED** by the 10th City Council of Valenzuela, in session assembled, that:

SECTION 1. Short Title, This Ordinance shall be known and cited shortly as the "Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling (PMOC) Program Ordinance".

SECTION 2. Declaration of Policy. It shall be the policy of the City of Valenzuela to:

- a. Recognize marriage as an inviolable social institution and the foundation of the family which in turn is the foundation of the nation;
- b. Protect and strengthen the family as a basic autonomous social institution;
- c. Ensure that couples are fully informed and equipped with necessary knowledge and skills in their expected roles and responsibilities as husband and wife, future parents and productive members of the society; and
- d. Provide Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling sessions to all contracting parties who are about to get married and require them to attend such sessions to prepare them to effectively assume their roles as spouses and parents.

SECTION 3. Adoption and Implementation of JMC No. 1 Series of 2018 on the Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling (PMOC) Program Implementing Guidelines of 2018. The current Pre-Marriage Counselling Program shall be strengthened through the adoption and implementation of the relevant provisions of the JMC No. 1, herewith attached and made as integral part of this Ordinance. Accordingly, the program be reorganized as Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling (PMOC) Program, which will provide the requisite Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling sessions to contracting parties applying for marriage license.



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SECTION 4. Organization and Mobilization of the Local PMOC Team.

A local PMOC Team shall be organized to oversee and efficiently perform the functions of the team prescribed in the JMC. The PMOC Team, shall be composed of:

- a. Appointed or designated City Population Officer – Team Leader;
- b. City Health and Nutrition Office representative – Member
- c. City Social Welfare Development Office representative – Member
- d. Local Civil Registry – Member
- e. City Agriculture Office representative - Member
- f. Representative from any other relevant local office as may be appointed by the City Mayor – Member

The City Population Management Office will provide secretarial support to the local PMOC Team and the implementation of the PMOC Program.

SECTION 5. Training of PMOC Team and Accreditation of PMC Counselors. To equip the members of the PMOC Team with the needed competency in the implementation of the program, all members of the team shall undergo relevant training in coordination and collaboration with national government agencies.

The Local PMOC team shall also have at least one (1) accredited Pre-Marriage Counselor who will provide Pre-Marriage Counselling session pursuant to the Family Code (EO 209). Initially, the members from the City Social Welfare Development Office shall comply with the accreditation requirements of the DSWD. Other members will be supported by the LGU to be able to complete the accreditation requirements of the DSWD.

SECTION 6. PMOC Protocols. The processes and procedures for the issuance of PMOC certificates shall comply with prescribed protocols under the JMC. It shall be the responsibility of the PMOC Team to inform the public about the protocols for compliance.



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SECTION 7. Online Registration and Digital Access. To improve accessibility, efficiency, and service delivery, the City Government shall establish and maintain an Online Registration System for PMOC applicants.

The Information and Communications Technology Office shall develop, manage, and maintain the system in coordination with the City Population Management Office and the Local Civil Registrar.

SECTION 8. PMOC Service Fee. A PMOC Service Fee of Fifty Pesos (₱50.00) shall be collected from each couple attending the Pre-Marriage Orientation and Counselling (PMOC) Seminar as a regulatory fee to cover the administrative and operational expenses of the Program.

The PMOC Service Fee shall be separate and distinct from any fees imposed for the application for and issuance of a Marriage License under existing laws, ordinances, and regulations.

The amount may be reviewed and adjusted by the City Council through an amendatory ordinance, when necessary.

All collections shall accrue to the General Fund of the City Government, subject to existing accounting and auditing rules and regulations.

SECTION 9. Reporting. The local PMOC Team shall maintain a PMOC database and regularly consolidate program implementation reports. The said reports of accomplishments shall be submitted to the Local Chief Executive and the PMOC Provincial and Regional TWGs annually.

SECTION 10. Confidentiality of the Database. Personal details of the contracting parties shall be stored and maintained confidentially by the PMOC Team, particularly the Local PMOC Secretariat. The PMOC Team must observe and respect data privacy rights of the contracting parties.

The use of any personal information collected, stored, and processed under the PMOC Program shall be subject to the rules and regulations as provided for by the Data Privacy Act of 2012 or RA 10173.

SECTION 11. Appropriations. The needed annual allocation for the efficient implementation of the PMOC program shall be included under the budget proposal of the City Population Management Office. Moreover, all local departments and offices participating in implementation of the PMOC Program



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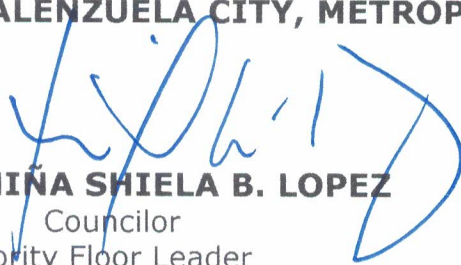
shall allocate in the respective annual investment plan the needed funding.

SECTION 12. Separability Clause. If any portion of this Ordinance is declared unconstitutional or invalid, the same shall not affect the validity of the other provisions affected thereby.

SECTION 13. Repealing Clause. All local ordinances, resolutions, orders, rules and regulations, or parts thereof inconsistent with the provisions of this Ordinance are hereby repealed or modified accordingly.

SECTION 14. Effectivity. This Ordinance shall take effect immediately upon approval.

ENACTED.
AUGUST 12, 2026
VALENZUELA CITY, METROPOLITAN MANILA.

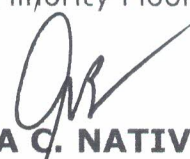

HON. NINA SHIELA B. LOPEZ
Councilor
Majority Floor Leader


HON. JOSEPH WILLIAM D. LEE
Councilor
Minority Floor Leader


HON. WALTER MAGNUM D. DELA CRUZ
Councilor
Asst. Majority Floor Leader

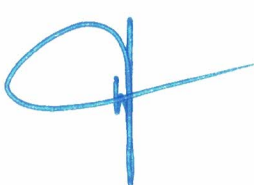
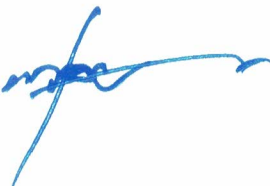

HON. LOUIE P. NOLASCO
Councilor
Asst. Minority Floor Leader

HON. CRISTINA MARIE FELICIANO-TAN
Councilor


HON. LORENA C. NATIVIDAD-BORJA
Councilor


HON. RICHARD C. ENRIQUEZ
Councilor


HON. ROSELLE SABINO-SY
Councilor





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HON. KISHA COLEEN R. ANCHETA
Councilor


HON. CHIQUI MARIE N. CARREON
Councilor

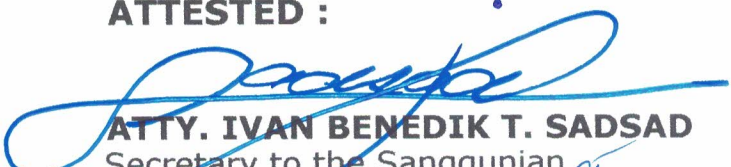

HON. EXEQUIEL D. SERRANO
Councilor

HON. CHRISTOFFER JOSEPH M. PINEDA
Councilor


HON. MARIO B. SAN ANDRES
Councilor
(President, League of Barangays)

HON. JAIRUS JEOFRI P. ESPLANA
Councilor
(President, Sangguniang Kabataan Federation)

ATTESTED :


ATTY. IVAN BENEDIK T. SADSAD
Secretary to the Sanggunian

CERTIFIED CORRECT:


HON. MARLON PAULO C. ALEJANDRINO
City Vice Mayor
Presiding Officer

APPROVED:


HON. WESLIE T. GATCHALIAN
City Mayor
Date signed : 07 SEP 2026